



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 10

FLORIDA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Florida's family courts and child-welfare system.

163

FLORIDA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 235
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 19 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 5, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

45 OF 67

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · FLORIDA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Florida. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Kristin KannerJUDGE · BROWARD · **5 FAMILIES**

"Issued and enforced a child pick-up order without an evidentiary hearing or record, ignored a pending motion to disqualify, and proceeded without due process or factual basis; within days of my pro se filings reporting judicial, attorney, and third-party misconduct, and despite being under criminal investigation related to my case, she refused to recuse, resulting in foreseeable harm including my child's hospitalization."

"Ordered the cross-state removal of my granddaughter from my partner's daughter, Kathryn Dressler, by armed police in another state despite documented domestic violence and safety concerns, after our family had already suffered the loss of multiple family members during these proceedings, compounding the harm to our family."

"My concerns have mainly been around due process—things like important issues being decided without enough time to present evidence, delays in hearing my motions, and procedural decisions that I don't feel have been applied evenly."

"Issued a cross-state child pickup order leading to the forced removal of my granddaughter from my daughter, Kathryn Dressler, by armed police while ignoring documented domestic violence and safety risks."

"My case has been delayed due to Nicole Vette's endless litigation abuse and Rynne Seyba GAL allowing it. Judge Kanner is allowing it to persist, too. 3.5 years and counting!"

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Joan Anthony

JUDGE · SEVENTH CIRCUIT COURT · 3 FAMILIES

"She was a defendant in my federal case while she presided over my tpr hearing and refused to recuse. She had me thrown in jail when i filed a motion to have her recuse for suppressing domestic violence evidence I disclosed and a motion for ADA accommodations for online court record viewing. The court window would not give me copies of filings or orders. She appointed counsel in abstentia on February 5, 2024 and had the attorney representing my husband substitute for the absent attorney. I was a domestic violence victim in my husband's current criminal case. The substitute attorney over talked me when i tried to disclose i was a victim of dv. He said he had to protect his clients interests, so he silenced me. Judge Anthony silenced me also when i tried to explain about the dv my husband did to me in front of my children. This happened during the continued shelter hearing. The first shelter hearing was held while I was at the Orlando Advent Children's hospital signing off on emergency brain surgery, Feb 2, 2024 for my special needs child. Judge Anthony issued a retroactive nunc pro tunc order on May 30, 2024 to conceal the conflicted counsel. Judge Kathleen McNeilly removed my disability attorney who was advocating for me during the Feb 2, 2024 shelter hearing. I had no attorney and there were three structural errors during the shelter hearings. Judge Anthony had the clerk not docket my filings. The appeal record was irregular and incomplete yet the 5th DCA knew this and issued a PCA to cover everything the lower tribunal did up. Finally, i informed her i was coerced into signing consent with no counsel present. The consebt form was misdsing the attorney signature block. And the attached notary was fraudulent voiding the document under Florida law. I informed Anthony, CPC, cm, pulled my mother's Florida homestudy out of the FSFN system foreclosing her guardian candidacy and changing the trajectory of the tpr. She deleted my filing. She committed judicial misconduct throughout my case and harmed my family."

"Presided over my daughter's TPR trial while named as a defendant in her civil rights case. Appointed counsel in abstention, and has the father's lawyer represent both parents conflict. Father has a criminal case where my daughter was victim. The substitute lawyer stopped my daughter from disclosing she was a victim of dv during the shelter hearing. Judge Anthony allowed FL DCF to use Devereux Behavioral Assessment reports and foster heresay to keep my granddaughter on a g-tube. FL DCF and the CBC, Community Partnership for Children removed an Easter Seals oral-motor evaluation documenting oral motor capacity from the case file to deny my daughter's request for a g-tube weaning evaluation. As a result of the medical neglect, my granddaughter had her right brain surgery on January 30, 2026. she is special needs and not seeing qualified medical specialists. Judge Anthony denied ADA accommodations to my daughter and I. She deleted all the substantive filings in the dependency case. She ignored my daughter disclosing she was coerced into signing consent, without counsel, by the fl DCF mediator who was the attorney appointed in absentia. The case manger altered the consent form to remove the attorney signature block. The case plan was never negotiated or signed. FI DCF never had jurisdiction, bit the judge ignored every violation. Despite all these procedural due process violations, The 5th DCA issued a PCA on 4-29-26." **VOLUSIA**

"Judge Anthony did not have the court clerk docket my pro se filings. They were substantive filings, including a motion to vacate and written opposition to TPR. She silenced me when I disclosed I was a victim of domestic violence. She mocked me during the proceedings and had me arrested after I filed motions for her recusal and ADA accommodations. She deleted emergency filings for medical care for my special needs infant to have a comprehensive evaluation. Florida DCF uses Behavioral Assessment reports to guide medical care in their cases in place of qualified medical professionals. This medical neglect and judicial misconduct is threatening my infant daughter's life. She ignored and suppressed dv in my case. As a result my children were nearly transferred back into a cycle of domestic violence when my husband filed for jurisdiction in AK. The court was provided multiple FOIA'd law enforcement reports documenting my husband's dv, kidnapping, rape and strangling me in front of my two younger children. She and the DCF attorneys and GALs kept laughing and doing inside jokes during the hearing."

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

FLORIDA AT A GLANCE.

Across 163 Florida families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 235 159 of 163 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$172,000 median across 73 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 19 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 57.1% 35.0% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 163	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.5	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 159 of 163	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 45

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Florida families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF FLORIDA FAMILY COURT

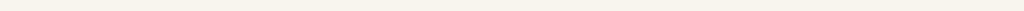
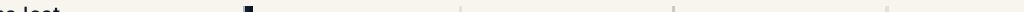
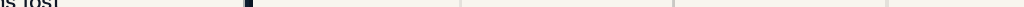
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

Expense Category	Responses	Median	Mean	Total Reported
Attorney Fees	97	\$30,000	\$56,470	\$5,477,618
Lost Wages	76	\$35,000	\$320,845	\$24,384,200
Other Court Fees	52	\$2,000	\$9,772	\$508,153
Therapy / Evaluations	66	\$2,200	\$10,984	\$724,970
Reunification Services	43	\$500	\$5,126	\$220,420
GAL Fees	47	\$1,200	\$16,608	\$780,565
Asset Loss ¹	68	\$64,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (73 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$172,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$64,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		19	1.6 yrs
Mean months lost		34	2.8 yrs
Total across all families		3,211	267.6 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · FLORIDA

Most families documenting in Florida are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		68	42%
Not provided		47	29%
Case closed: within last 2 years		19	12%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		15	9%
Active case: progress being made		5	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		64	39%
Family Court Only		40	25%
Unknown		30	18%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		25	15%
Family Court		1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		41	25%
3 – 5 years		28	17%
5 – 10 years		27	17%
Less than 6 months		14	9%
5+ years		14	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		52	32%
50/50 Joint		32	20%
Visitation Only		22	13%
Full Custody		16	10%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		16	10%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Broward		8	5%
Polk		7	4%
Orange		7	4%
Pinellas		7	4%
Volusia		6	4%
Escambia		5	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		38	23%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		31	19%
Other: (Short answer)		15	9%
High Conflict Divorce		14	9%
Family Court		14	9%

05 PARENT VOICES — FLORIDA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Florida comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



This experience has caused trauma beyond that of a narcissistic abuser. The amount of trauma inflicted by the department of children and families and their affiliates Lutheran services and children's network is far worse than anything I experienced with my children's father. I [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

THE SYSTEM DESTROYED MY SONS EMOTIONAL MENTAL WELL BEING BY ALLOWING A MENTALLY ILL, SUBSTANCE ABUSER ABUSE THE COURT PROCESS AND TIE HIM UP CONSTANTLY WITH LEGAL AND COERCE THE LITTLE GIRL (PARENTAL ALIENATION) AGAINST MY SON AND US. IT FINANCIALLY RUINED MY SON AND HIS NEW [...]

— FLORIDA PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM FLORIDA

Ruined all of us I suffer from PTSD trauma, anxiety, torture, because I think about my daughters every day they're being well taken care of my family is extremely disappointed. My mother passed away, never met my daughters and her final words were for me to do whatever it takes [...]

— BRUNA

Family court is a broken system, attorneys all say they same they want to help they care, bullshit they just want money. You can have proof but once your in the system there is no way of getting out. You are stuck spending money and have to sit and watch your children suffer. [...]

— VANESSA

Left me broken inside, being a mom is my greatest blessing and my kids were stolen from me without even asking me what happened or hearing me at all.

— CHASTITY

Traumatized my children (and the parents), caused punitive damages, emotional harm, financial issues, etc

— MELISSA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This has destroyed my children - A+ students down to Fs and suspensions from school, mental issues and suicidal thoughts, major health issues with their father denying anything being wrong with them, kids surviving regular abuse while their father hides behind "corporal [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore us apart and broke many bonds #KaynTay Pamela Bokhoven #KaynTay Shop and Outreach Campaign Manager, aoa-anc.org Justice and Accountability Act Committee written by Francesca Amato Francesca Amato 325-225-8050 Subject: Urgent Call for Family Justice and Accountability Reform [...]

— PAM

All family courts are corrupted. Facts of your case are irrelevant as the courts act in their own financial interest through Title IVd of the Welfare Act. The actual facts don't matter to the attorneys and Judges.

— JOHN

Taken away the rights of my children and myself.

— THOMAS

Systematic psychological abuse, financial abuse, civil rights violations, parental rights violations, FERPA violations

— DUSTIN

Family court consistently leaned into parental rights over children's rights leaving them 50% of the time with an unsafe documented abuser and alcoholic.

— SAMANTHA

My mental and physical health has degraded my financial ability when I had to file for disability in 2023 was devastated and pretty much destroyed.

— MICHAEL

Fuck family court. Family court profits off abuse, parent conflict and ongoing conflict. The judges and attorneys have no oversight or accountability. They lie, cheat and steal.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated me from my kids and has caused behavior issues with my daughter

— LATONYA

Family court has destroyed my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my kids with no reason behind this?

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



DCF/CPS ruins children and destroys families for profit. They destroyed the bond that I had with my children. Trust was lost and my children and I struggle with that every day. And my children and I have all turned to drugs or alcohol to kill the pain. And one of my son's has be [...]

— TRACI

The last 5 years have been truly horrific. My ex has used the courts to legally, financially, and mentally abuse all the while continuing to physically mentally emotionally and spiritually abuse our boys. I was promised 5 years ago that the attorney I paid would see the process [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system destroys families creating trauma across multiple generations

— STEPHANIE

They destroyed my life and my family and my life

— STEPHANIE

This system didn't protect our family—it destroyed it. My brother's three children were taken in the middle of the night and split apart into different homes, stripping them not only from their father but from each other. Siblings who were raised together have been denied even [...]

— DAVID

Taken a retired female Air Force veteran to question how she could ever lay her life on the line for a corrupt judicial system .

— SACHEL

Because of this system I have no family, and my children are missing a vital part of theirs.

— DANIELLE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It has broken my trust in support for woman and children such as myself and my daughter, it has caused me severe depression, it has gotten me ill, caused strife in my family, has caused financial hardship and my daughter has been handed to an abuser to be traumatized and [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I already put before, but violated due process caused harm to the children, confusion, took time away made the children believe they were liars and confused them of what truth is and enabled financial and mental and emotional abuse of myself and the kids to continue and extreme [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Harm, PTSD, damages, lost of all my kids young moment. Puberty, teen time completely loss.

— NYULKA

Split the family up adopted to strangers when siblings and other relatives were available to care for children

— BRENDA

The system has caused significant distress to our family, impacting our children and traumatizing my wife and me, as well as our five children. We are seeking justice and accountability for these actions.

— PAUL

Stolen parts of me that I'll ever get back. I'm mourning people that are still alive and I hold it together every day for the sake of myself and my other two kids

— BROOKE

When they walked into my life this last time I had Recently married my boyfriend from when I was 16 years old, we had three kids. We lived across the street from his parents. We had a new pick up truck . We needed help with housing upgrades and communication and some other [...]

— THYME

The impact is too great and devastating to describe in 1 or 2 sentences. Our hearts are shattered due to the loss, but as a family we will continue to advocate for the children to be returned to a loving home and stop the emotional and phycological abuse by the father.

— TRACI

You took our children, so all we had was whole lot of time and pissed off. You had money, I had the truth, and it set my children free.

— CRYSTAL

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



My family was destroyed by family court and Dr. Deborah O. Day. We were a loving family and I was their mom! My daughters were removed from my care in a hearing that the 5th District Court of Appeals said that Judge Shawn L. Briese denied Mother's due process and the hearing to [...]

— LINDA MARIE

Shattered self and family. Human trafficking violations. Child abuse. The “justice” system is broken.

— TANYA

This system has allowed an abusive addict to destroy my children and my family and has allowed a former attorney without a bar card for drugs to have unfettered access to addict my children to drugs..

— STACI

Empowered the abuser, punished the abused.

— MELISSA

They illegally stole my 5 children off lies and expedited TPR . They are keeping them in foster care when there is a relative who has passed a home study to take them. They are keeping them for profit rather than placing them with family.

— MARISSA

Tore families apart on false accusations..... robbed me of precious memories lost. Brain washed the children in fear tactics. Placed them in much worse conditions then prior.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my life as a mother, made me struggle to get by while I was my kids only parent. Never once held him accountable and he owes over 250,000 in support. After the trial, I was to I have to prove his ability to pay and I need a lawyer

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system destroyed four people who had never done a single thing wrong and who were just trying to live their life happily and together. All evidence was ignored, assumptions were made, and it destroyed us completely. There was not a single shred of evidence anywhere that [...]

— CAITLIN

While DCF acted swiftly to remove our newborn based on allegations, they showed no concern for the well-being of our older children, one of whom is nonverbal and requires daily support, demonstrating a disconnect between their stated concerns and their actual actions.

— FRANK

108 Florida parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — FLORIDA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Florida families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

This experience has caused trauma beyond that of a narcissistic abuser. The amount of trauma inflicted by the department of children and families and their affiliates Lutheran services and children's network is far worse than anything I experienced with my children's father. I would not wish this on my worst enemy. My relationship with my older daughter has been destroyed at the hands of a court appointed caregiver, her paternal grandmother and witnessed by the GAL, caseworker, her supervisor and the department of children and families lawyer, recommendations have been made on lies and slander. I'm just in total dismay that they can blatantly violate Florida's statute and standards toward reunification. And no one is being held accountable for their wrong doings. I have gone to the OIG the ombudsman, the DCF civil rights office and they have yet to show concern, I'm not the only one this happening to in this county. This mom is not stopping until justice is had!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined all of us I suffer from PTSD trauma, anxiety, torture, because I think about my daughters every day they're being well taken care of my family is extremely disappointed. My mother passed away, never met my daughters and her final words were for me to do whatever it takes to get my daughters back, my dad is getting old and he has medical issues and his wish is to meet his granddaughters the first twins in my family in our generation and I could not have kids. They ruined me destroyed me. They took my soul and ripped out my heart. I felt like I died that day I lost interest and a lot of things in life. I'm disappointed completely with the system. I don't believe in justice.

— BRUNA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

THE SYSTEM DESTROYED MY SONS EMOTIONAL MENTAL WELL BEING BY ALLOWING A MENTALLY ILL, SUBSTANCE ABUSER ABUSE THE COURT PROCESS AND TIE HIM UP CONSTANTLY WITH LEGAL AND COERCE THE LITTLE GIRL (PARENTAL ALIENATION) AGAINST MY SON AND US. IT FINANCIALLY RUINED MY SON AND HIS NEW WIFE, RUINED HIS REPUTATION AS HE WAS BEING SERVED PAPERS AT HIS WORK FOR ABUSE, CHILD ABUSE, SEXUAL ABUSE ANYTHING THAT WOULD DELAY VISITATION SHE USED HER CONTACTS IN THE KY SYSTEM TO DELAY VISITATIONS SET BY FLORIDA. COMMITTED CONTENTPT 3 TIMES WITH NO RECOURSE WAS DUE 465 MAKE UP DAYS AND HAD TO GIVE UP. MY SON AND HIS WIFE ARE NO LONGER WITH US 10/06/2026 THEY WERE BOTH FOUND DEAD THE WEEKEND HE WAS SUPPOSED TO FINALLY SEE HIS DAUGHTER AS THE MOTHER SAID SHE WAS NOT BRINGING THE DAUGHTER FOR HIS ONE LONG WEEEEKEND BECAUSE THE DAUGHTER DIDN'T WANT TO GO, AGAIN CONTEMPT OF THE COURT ORDER AND UPON MY SONS DEATH I ASKED FOR THE CUSTODY PLAN WHICH IS MINIMAL AND SHE DENIED ME AND MY HUSBAND (GRANDPARENTS) VISITATION OR COMMUNICATION. I HAVE NO MORE MONEY TO FIGHT TO SEE AND THIS GIRL ATTEMPTED SUICIDE, WAS AN ADMITTED DRUG/SUBSTANCE ABUSER SINCE 14, HER FATHER EXTORTED, BRIBED, COERCED MY SON TO GIVE UP OR HE WOULD HAVE HIM IMPRISONED THE MCCRACKEN COUNTY SHERRIF TOOK FALSE POLICE REPORTS AND RESPONDED WITH WARRANTS THAT WOULD NOT HOLD UP, AND THEN THE FATHER THE EX-COMMISSIONER BAITED MY SON AS WELL AS THE MOTHER TO COMMUNICATED OUTSIDE OF TALKING PARENTS ONLY TO FILE VIOLATION OF EPO, TOTALLY ABUSED THE SYSTEM AND COST ME MY SON, AS HE IS NO LONGER WITH US AS WELL AS MY GRANDAUGHER , MY ONLY PIECE OF MY SON I HAVE LEFT. I FINALLY HAD HER EVALUATED AND HAVE ON VIDEO AND COUNSERLOR IN DISBELIEF

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

WATCHING THIS LITTLE GIRL ADMIT TO LYING BECAUSE HER MOTHER IS DOING THIS TO HER WHICH IS CHILD ABUSE AT ITS EXTREME. THE SYSTEM IS NOT FOR THE KIDS AND SO MANY ARE DAMAGED BEYOND COMPREHENSION WHEN SOMEONE KNOWS HOW TO ABUSE THE SYSTEM

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

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Tore us apart and broke many bonds #KaynTay Pamela Bokhoven #KaynTay Shop and Outreach Campaign Manager, aoa-anc.org Justice and Accountability Act Committee written by Francesca Amato Francesca Amato 325-225-8050 Subject: Urgent Call for Family Justice and Accountability Reform Dear [Senator/Congress Members I am writing to you as both a concerned mother and an advocate dedicated to protecting families from the devastating effects of forced adoptions and systemic failures in child welfare. My organization, #KaynTay Shop and Outreach, works tirelessly to support parents navigating these unjust systems. As someone who has personally experienced the removal and permanent adoption of my child without due process, I have witnessed firsthand the emotional, legal, and social consequences of these policies. Families are torn apart, parents are silenced, and children are placed in situations that may not serve their best interests. This crisis demands urgent attention and decisive action from our elected leaders. I strongly urge you to support the Family Justice and Accountability Act, ensuring rigorous oversight, transparency, and accountability in child welfare cases. Families deserve a system that protects their rights and prioritizes unity, not profit or bureaucracy. Your leadership can bring much-needed justice to countless families across our nation. Thank you for your attention to this critical matter. I welcome the opportunity to discuss these issues further and provide any testimony or documentation that may assist in shaping policy that truly serves families. Sincerely, Pamela Bokhoven #KaynTay Shop and Outreach

— PAM

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— TRACI

The last 5 years have been truly horrific. My ex has used the courts to legally, financially, and mentally abuse all the while continuing to physically mentally emotionally and spiritually abuse our boys. I was promised 5 years ago that the attorney I paid would see the process through and \$60,000 was wasted on emails and phone calls. It wasn't until I threatened to go to the Florida Bar Association that she started to show up. Not a single motion was filed by her to push the process aside from the original filings. Due to the action of this money hungry lawyer I am let to fend for myself while my children continue to endure the abuse from their father.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system destroys families creating trauma across multiple generations

— STEPHANIE

They destroyed my life and my family and my life

— STEPHANIE

This system didn't protect our family—it destroyed it. My brother's three children were taken in the middle of the night and split apart into different homes, stripping them not only from their father but from each other. Siblings who were raised together have been denied even the basic right to speak or see one another, including a brother they've been completely cut off from. From the very beginning, our entire family was shut out. Calls went unanswered, messages ignored, and every attempt to be involved was met with excuses or silence. It wasn't just neglect—it felt intentional, like barriers were put in place to prevent reunification instead of support it. Decisions were made based on twisted narratives and incomplete truths, while a stable home and years of care were disregarded. Instead of helping children stay connected to the people who raised and loved them, the system chose separation, disconnection, and permanent damage. What was taken from us wasn't just custody—it was a family bond that can't be replaced. And years later, we are still living with the consequences of a system that failed the very people it was supposed to protect.

— DAVID

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Taken a retired female Air Force veteran to question how she could ever lay her life on the line for a corrupt judicial system .

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— PAUL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Stolen parts of me that I'll ever get back. I'm mourning people that are still alive and I hold it together every day for the sake of myself and my other two kids

— BROOKE

When they walked into my life this last time I had Recently married my boyfriend from when I was 16 years old, we had three kids. We lived across the street from his parents. We had a new pick up truck . We needed help with housing upgrades and communication and some other things but, my husband is now in prison and has been 2 years, my children have never gotten to open presents together on Christmas morning let alone other millions of missed connections love and quality time. They even lied about the date the incident happened and told me it was normal curiosity!!!!!! My baby was only 5 years old he is 13 years old!!!! And I told my judge and everyone I spoke to for 2 years that something was wrong with my daughter and I was told to shut up and stop putting ideas in her head!!!!

— THYME

The impact is too great and devastating to describe in 1 or 2 sentences. Our hearts are shattered due to the loss, but as a family we will continue to advocate for the children to be returned to a loving home and stop the emotional and phycological abuse by the father.

— TRACI

You took our children, so all we had was whole lot of time and pissed off. You had money, I had the truth, and it set my children free.

— CRYSTAL

My family was destroyed by family court and Dr. Deborah O. Day. We were a loving family and I was their mom! My daughters were removed from my care in a hearing that the 5th District Court of Appeals said that Judge Shawn L. Briese denied Mother's due process and the hearing to determine custody should never have taken place as Mother's hand written Motion for Continuance was legally sufficient and should never have been denied. How can this happen in the United States of America? This is happening all over the US and this is a travesty of justice. Linda Marie Sacks

— LINDA MARIE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Shattered self and family. Human trafficking violations. Child abuse. The “justice” system is broken.

— TANYA

This system has allowed an abusive addict to destroy my children and my family and has allowed a former attorney without a bar card for drugs to have unfettered access to addict my children to drugs..

— STACI

Empowered the abuser, punished the abused.

— MELISSA

They illegally stole my 5 children off lies and expedited TPR . They are keeping them in foster care when there is a relative who has pasted a home study to take them. They are keeping them for profit rather then placing them with family.

— MARISSA

Tore families apart on false accusations..... robbed me of precious memories lost. Brain washed the children in fear tactics. Placed them in much worse conditions then prior.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my life as a mother, made me struggle to get by while I was my kids only parent. Never once held him accountable and he owes over 250,000 in support. After the trial, I was to I have to prove his ability to pay and I need a lawyer

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system destroyed four people who had never done a single thing wrong and who were just trying to live their life happily and together. All evidence was ignored, assumptions were made, and it destroyed us completely. There was not a single shred of evidence anywhere that would even imply that we would hurt our children and it was ignored, and We went from a happy family in a good neighborhood with great friends and family to absolutely nothing.

— CAITLIN

While DCF acted swiftly to remove our newborn based on allegations, they showed no concern for the well-being of our older children, one of whom is nonverbal and requires daily support, demonstrating a disconnect between their stated concerns and their actual actions.

— FRANK

Suspended my majority timesharing and made it supervised and gave the other side majority timesharing in a different state based off false allegations of abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Failure of judge to rules of civil procedure, and established laws/statutes.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

After surviving a kidnapping which included 2 attempted murders, and 4 rapes, I was then tortured by the system to cover up their repeated failures.

— ALISA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This Broward County Family Court system caused devastating harm to our family long before the seizure of my granddaughter, including the loss of multiple family members as a result of prolonged proceedings. The court then ordered her taken across state lines from my daughter in Darien, Georgia—while the father resides in Miami—returning her to a dangerous environment despite evidence of abuse. I was physically present and personally witnessed the seizure as armed police took my granddaughter while she was crying, screaming, and begging not to be taken. This caused further irreversible harm, including medical collapse, trauma to multiple disabled family members, and the destruction of our entire family structure. All of this has been repeatedly documented and reported to multiple courts, agencies, and oversight bodies, with no meaningful action taken. I worry every single day about my daughter and granddaughter, and that my partner or I may pass away before ever being able to see my granddaughter again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn my family to pieces..irrivocably damaged relationships.

— JACQUELINE

DCF has forever changed me as a person, mother, wife and friend. I have no faith or trust in our government or people anymore.

— KRISTIN

While no actual time was lost with my child, as I CHOSE to enter a 2 year program, we have suffered severe mental, physical, emotional, and spiritual trauma do to the ignorance and lack of due diligence by my CPS investigator and team.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Broke me mentally emotionally, and financially also destroyedmy three boys relationship with their mother and their outlook on what a happy healthy family should be.

— SHELLEY

False allegations had my kids taken away , myself oldest son and bf thrown in jail fighting for our life , crooked detective fabricated evidence Google me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This systematic dismantling of my life has functioned as a total institutional erasure, stripping away my motherhood, my professional identity, and my sanctuary all at once. It is the profound trauma of being forced to fight for my basic humanity against the very systems designed to protect it, leaving a legacy of stolen time and unearned stigma that no court order can easily undo.

— CHRISTINA

It has made me completely irrelevant and my children have a constant feeling of being lost. Without a mother's love and guidance it's hard to be loved.

— MONA

Irreparable damage to my professional reputation and my child's reputation.

— KRISTIN

It has caused so much division and destruction and grief in mine and my children's lives... I spoke up for myself and them and they failed to protect us

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my relationship with my children to the point my daughter states to DCF/Police "I love snuggling with daddy, but daddy is a bad man, he is mean to my mommy"...

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Violated and dismantled us. With no empathy, no regard for my children and their futures and no sense of morality, family court and DCF continue their heinous tirades on us and we are tired.

— AMY

The State of Florida has weaponized the dependency system to turn my children into federal revenue streams, using fabricated evidence to kidnap them and judicial misconduct to hold them hostage, effectively trafficking them through foster care to harvest Title IV-E bounties.

— PAUL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have stole my entire world made my life unmanageable my babies need me they want me

— HEARTHER

Trying make parents separate and division between extended family. Mother and son etc

— ANGELLA

Litigation abuse, torn my family apart, put my son in an extremely toxic environment !

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The broken system has only shown me how much we can't trust anyone. Which is sad because those are the people who promised to uphold the law and they are far from it. My heart breaks every day. I can't sleep, I cry randomly, I can't put on any weight and keep it, I feel defeated and discouraged by this. All I want to do is care for my kids and be there with and for them. What I did all their lives up until we were ripped apart. It's been more than two years now and I don't even feel like a mom anymore. Despite not having my babies, they are the only ones keeping me going. I stay strong for them. I just want justice. I want people to be held accountable for separating and alienating a mother from her children and splitting siblings up.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Irreplaceable damages Motherhood, Childhood

— MELISSA

They have completely destroyed my grandkids, my husband, and myself. All over a lie that was proven to be a lie and still three kids weren't returned to us. There's also lies that have been given to my niece whom has the kids in paperwork. Blaten disgusting lies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system destroyed my family for years almost causing me to take my own life. After over 5 years and finally being reunified they have caused serious emotional damage to the relationship between my children and I as well as the sibling bonds from being separated for so long.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my family.

— ALMA

Caused endless problems, depression, kept putting us in prison and jail

— BRENDA

Lack of timely hearings, denial of time to properly hear final trial, allowed false testimony to be admitted into final order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system that is designed to protect children and families, manipulated all involved to tear us apart for funding. They put a price on my child's head and holds him for funding, while we are torn apart only a year after my oldest child's death.

— REBEKAH

What my family has been through because of the system is incomprehensible. What is supposed to protect us has allowed for us to be continually abused with nowhere to turn. At this point I just pray. I pray for the safety of my children physically, mentally, and spiritually. At the end of the day all I can do is show up for them, and just pray.

— SARA

The system protects its own while making sure nothing is worked out.

— STEVE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system failed my children by not properly investigating serious injuries and ignoring medical and forensic concerns, while continuing to rely on the same investigator despite documented issues. This failure directly impacts their safety, mental health, and well-being

— RORY

They have removed her and refused to allow a kinship placement despite that being what is required. They have shattered our world and hers

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Fl DCF is endangering my infant granddaughters life. She has complex special needs and is not receiving adequate medical care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system didn't protect my children - it prolonged harm, drained our resources, and forced us to fight for safety instead of receiving it. I don't blame my ex-husband, if I had expected him to do the right thing, I wouldn't have left him- I blame the Clay County family court system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My child was taken through backroom orders with no hearing, no proof, and no accountability, and every attempt I made to protect her was ignored while the system closed ranks to protect itself. This system stripped me of my child through unrecorded, unsupported orders and then denied me any meaningful way to fight back, turning due process into an illusion and leaving my family devastated.

— KATHRYN

This system has kept me fearful of living my life in so many ways its hard to describe. The constant interference with my driver's license crippling my ability to have reliable employment! I do ac and refrigeration in Florida so during the winters when my work was slow I'd loose my job because of having my license suspended due to falling behind in child support! Never was my work being seasonal considered or calculated in the support amounts! I also had a family at home i was supporting that again they never considered the impact it had on them! Title 4d are frauds!

— JEFFREY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

CIRCUIT SEVEN IS GARBAGE.

— AUBREY

The system has humiliated and degraded me and rendered me voiceless and unable to advocate for my child and myself. Court mandated therapy with no clear expectations did not lead to healing but only added trauma to our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court system has taken a survivor of domestic violence and has punished her and her children for seeking relief from the very person who harmed them. (Broward County, FL- FMCE 20-3810)

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Words can't describe the impact this case has had on me and my family. Severe emotional distress and psychological trauma is an understatement. A lifetime of therapy won't be able to stop the nightmares I have every night of the moment they led my daughter into the other room and out of my life, the pit in my stomach I get everytime I see her bedroom door.

— AMBER MAY

Destroyed my family and not allowing my granddaughter to have her mom or growing up with knowing all her family, Causing my granddaughter depression and behavior problems, sadness. Causing my daughter to not want to live without her daughter, making her sick. Its like a death that you never stop grieving.

— JENNIFER

I lost my chance at college. I lost jobs. I lost family. I almost lost my husband. I lost some of my youth. I lost my house. I lost my mental health and physical health. Almost died last pregnancy.

— ZOEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

As a law enforcement officer for 28 years I have used the law as a tool to help the community. The the law is used to abuse the process knowing I have to follow all the rules to keep my job but she doesn't. She thinks she can make the boys men without a father who is fit and willing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ignored a active criminal investigation. Broke a lawful protection order and returned the child during an active protection order against her alleged abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This corruption has taken my son from me and my/his family his father is now deceased siblings he has never met along with grandparents cousins etc I've literally lost my heart and soul being without my son I would never have a life and be the same again I just want him back I want this to stop it's not fair I have no desire for life as I did my only son is in a foster home with a gay couple which goes against my beliefs and is completely wrong in my opinion and he has a loving mother right here that needs and wants him very much I'll never stop and have fear and worry every sec that he could be in harm God please give me my son back

— SHELLY

Our entire family is shattered beyond repair, physically, emotionally and psychologically.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined our entire lives.

— LISA

They wouldn't let me be a child with my family . They wouldn't let me have a family without interfering and trying to steal my kids . Even after beating them at trial they wait and attack your kids when they have kids . It's generational attacking peoples family's . They could care less only about what they get paid by doing this to family's

— LEE ANN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Broken my family into 3 different states . Still haven't filed icpc that was court ordered months ago . Giving me no clear answer on how to get them back . Threaten me with termination if I speak out or file any complaint against judge or lawyer . Refuse physical visits if I bring my 8 month old to Florida they will take him . Refuse to send my child to my family willing to take him. Refuse reunification services.

— TABITHA

No worlds to describe the pain and how exhausted I am

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Dissected my family.

— AMANDA

This system has taken my life and turned it upside down with no signs of overturning an emergency decision that was made without emergency safeguards. An absolute failure of the system that depended on a LIE leaving me on the outside of my child's life, looking in.

— J

I can't let myself love another child, not like that. I'm guarded. I don't trust anyone who works in the system. They didn't want me to have the girls and I fought for them. They didn't want the parents to have them either

— THERESA

My husband has been creating conflictive situations for the last years, then record me and he used them to accuse me of domestic violence. I lost access to my children, even being an educator for 15 years and working at the same school. I have no home or my belongings. Never I had a record of violence. I have not had yet an opportunity to present my evidence or be heard. How can this be real?

— ESTHE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It's deplorable that we begging to hold our babies using words (your honor) that hold more respect than mothers have collectively been given. When will it please the court to evolve past vocabulary that is more mature than their current

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

DCF lied tried to help the father because they had a friendship. Tore my son from me his primary caregiver and his primary home. Causing me great emotional distress and the child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system in Broward county 17th judicial circuit family courts is destroying families and protective parents on purpose. My child is severely mentally harmed and I have no way to help her. We need urgent help in this courthouse

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They dun fug with me dawg

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Jennifer Bass denied my time back and broke Florida laws! She sided with the mother who had NO EVIDENCE and lied under oath!! Sje also committed judicial misconduct

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As a woman who already has overcome situations that could likely extinguish a life, who has PTSD and chose a career in which I can serve others this experience has been wrought with absolute malice at the hands of those who swore to protect the innocent. My child has always been my main motivation and priority and to separate from an increasingly dangerous and violent marriage to have my minor taken from me was soul crushing. They ignited a fire however that at this point would be visible from the cosmos.

— LINDSEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I've been so distressed I couldn't sleep or eat, which lead to malnutrition. I sprained my ankle two weeks ago and have been out of work since. The bloodwork suggests I was malnourished.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The broken Family Court has irreparably harmed myself, my Daughter, and her adult siblings who had abuse continue and escalated because the safe parent was removed and erased. My violent, abusive Ex Husband has continued to stalk and threaten me and was empowered to beat Wife #4 and her Son after me when the Court failed to stop him.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has violated and ignored my constitutional rights as a parent. No criminal or drug background. Stand custody in another state is being violated and no one will help help get my child back from a convicted felon who has unlawfully removed the child from the state denying access to her mother in whom has primary custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system, along with my ex, has completely severed my relationship with my son. He now has been cut off from both sides of his family. There is no one to help. And there is no hope.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am currently experiencing ongoing parental alienation, where my relationship with my child has been deliberately interfered with through restricted contact and misrepresentation of my role as a parent. This situation has caused significant emotional distress and continues to harm both my bond with my child and her overall well-being.

— GIA

Florida DCF medically kidnapped my specials needs child who was weaning. The agency put her back on a g-tube and used behavioral assessment reports by Licensed Mental Health Counselors instead of qualified professionals to unnecessarily keep her g-tube dependent for 3 years. She is not seeing proper neurologists and suffering medical neglect.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Despite the challenges created by the Guardian ad Litem Traci Powells report and the outcome of the proceedings, my household has remained stable and consistent. I have maintained a structured environment, daily routines, and a focus on my child's emotional and physical well-being. However, I am concerned that decisions influenced by inaccurate or incomplete information have created external instability that impacts my ability to fully protect and advocate for my child's best interests.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

108 full approved Florida comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Florida report comes from Florida respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Florida — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 163 Florida families reporting here are not the universe of Florida families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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